Pet Memory Lab

First Meeting Summary • October 27 2026

We're keeping the project small initially: a pet companion that retrieves memories using embedding search and keyword search, so we can compare what each method finds. We will add on top of this later.

What we are building

Add an owner fact → ask a question → see the memories returned by both methods side by side. Keyword search matches words; embedding search looks for similar meaning. We'll compare both using the same facts and questions. Fancy pet features can wait.

Everyone's checklist for Friday October 30

☐ **Kavya:** Build a runnable skeleton interface with Add a fact, Ask a question, and two result areas. Mock results are fine this week; label them clearly so we know what is real.

☐ **Carlos:** Get a basic embedding retrieval setup running, embed a few sample facts, store them, and query them to retrieve relevant memories. Include setup steps and one example that works.

☐ **Kenny:** Catch up with DV, pick a small subtask to contribute to with Kavya or Carlos, and share what you've tried by Friday. We'll agree on the exact piece after the briefing.

☐ **DV:** Share the initialized GitHub repo and a starter README with the proposed stack and setup. Brief Kenny and help everyone agree on how the UI and search code will connect.

A simple Python stack to start with

Proposal to confirm before connecting everything: Streamlit for the interface; sentence-transformers with all-MiniLM-L6-v2 for embeddings; local Chroma for the vector database. Use simple Python word matching for the keyword baseline. Keep dependencies in requirements.txt, setup steps in the README, and a few checks in pytest. No paid AI API is needed right now.

How we will work and what comes next

By Friday, October 30th: put your code and run instructions in the repo and share a short update. If you're stuck or need more time, tell the group early so we can help. Keep tasks small, ask questions, and bring something we can try together.

Next, connect the interface to real retrieval, choose who owns the keyword baseline, and compare the two methods.

Week of November 16: show progress and explain who this helps.
December 3: present the working demo and what we learned.

Streamlit Sentence Transformers Chroma